

WORLD LANGUAGES OVERVIEW

There are approximately 7000 languages spoken in the world today.

Mandarin Chinese is the most spoken language with over 1.1 billion native speakers.

English is the most widely learned second language and is used by over 1.5 billion people.

Spanish has 485 million native speakers and is the official language of 20 countries.

Hindi has 345 million speakers and is one of the official languages of India.

Arabic has 310 million speakers and is the liturgical language of Islam.

The Basque language is considered a language isolate with no known relatives.

Papua New Guinea has 840 languages, the most linguistic diversity of any country.

The oldest known written language is Sumerian, dating back to 3100 BCE.

Esperanto was created in 1887 as an international auxiliary language.